

Grill Station Closing and Grate Seasoning

Owner: Priya Nair (Sous Chef, Grill)

1. Purpose and Scope

- Close the Grill station safely and consistently every night.
- Covers burner shutdown order, grate scraping and seasoning, flat-top cleaning, grease management, hood filter check, sanitizing, and sign-off.
- Applies to: Grill cooks and closing lead.

2. Safety and Tools

- PPE: dry side towels, heat-resistant gloves, apron, cut-resistant glove for scraping.
- Tools: grill scraper, wire brush, chain mail/scrub pad, grill brick/pumice, long tongs, squeeze bottles (water and oil), 2 qt metal bain for oil waste, lined grease caddy, sanitized buckets, blue towels.
- Chemicals: degreaser (for flat-top and hood filters), dish soap, approved sanitizer (chlorine or quats) with test strips.
- Hot surfaces stay above 300°F for cleaning; allow to cool before sanitizing to avoid chemical flash-off.

3. Burner Shutdown Order

1. Kill active flames in this order: side auxiliary burners, salamander/cheese melter, flat-top, then main grill burners.
2. Turn all control knobs to OFF. Verify no flame at each burner port.
3. Close the gas appliance valves (quarter-turn) from right to left along the line.
4. If directed by MOD, close the station's main gas shutoff.
5. Switch off ignition systems and pilot lights only if maintenance or deep-clean is scheduled; otherwise leave pilots per chef's direction.

4. Grill Grates: Scrape and Season

6. While grates are still hot (350–450°F), use grill scraper to push debris to the crumb tray. Empty tray into compost/trash as directed.
7. Brush grates top and underside with wire brush. Use chain mail on stubborn carbon; avoid gouging.
8. Wipe with a lightly oiled towel on tongs to pick up fine residue.
9. Seasoning coat:

- Heat grates to about 400°F.
- Apply a thin film of high-smoke point oil (canola or rice bran) using a folded towel on tongs. Do not pour oil directly on flame.
- Let oil polymerize for 2–3 minutes until a dry sheen forms. Repeat 1 additional thin coat if grates look dull or patchy.

10. Final pass: wipe with a clean, dry towel to remove excess. Grates should look dark and satin, not wet.

Oil Guide for Seasoning

- Use: canola or rice bran oil.
- Avoid: butter, extra-virgin olive oil.
- Target temp: ~400°F surface; no visible smoking.

5. Flat-Top Cleaning

11. With flat-top warm (300–350°F), scrape food soil to the trough. Dump trough into lined grease caddy.
12. Deglaze: squirt water to steam-release stuck bits; scrape to trough. Repeat until runoff is clear.
13. Stubborn spots: apply a small amount of degreaser per label or use grill brick/pumice with a few drops of oil. Scrub in circles; avoid low spots.
14. Neutral rinse: light water, scrape dry. Turn heat OFF and allow steel to cool below 140°F.
15. Season: when warm, wipe a teaspoon of canola oil over the surface to a thin sheen. No pooling.

6. Grease Management and Trap Check

16. Empty grill crumb tray and flat-top trough into lined grease caddy. Do not pour into sinks or floor drains.
17. Wipe exterior drip ledges and valve areas with degreaser; rinse with hot water; dry.
18. Under-unit grease drawer: remove, cap, and transfer to waste oil tank if at fill line. Replace liner.
19. Floor grease interceptor check:
 - Verify lid is seated and area is clean/dry.
 - If flow is slow or odor present, note in log and notify MOD for service.

7. Hood Filter Check

20. Inspect baffle filters above Grill and Flat-Top. If more than half the surface is occluded or dripping, pull for wash.

21. Wash: run through dish machine with degreaser or soak in hot water with degreaser, then rinse and air-dry.
22. Reinstall with arrows pointing up; ensure a tight fit. Wipe hood edges and light lenses.

8. Sanitizing and Final Surfaces

- Only sanitize cooled, cleaned food-contact surfaces (<120°F) for proper contact time.

Sanitizer	Target ppm	Contact time	Notes
Chlorine	50–100 ppm	1 min	Use test strips; change when cloudy or <50 ppm
Quats	200–400 ppm	1 min	No rinse on food-contact surfaces; air-dry

Steps:

23. Mix sanitizer per label. Verify ppm with test strips.
24. Wipe down: grill front ledges, shelves, utensil holders, knobs, handles, reach-in and lowboy handles, prep boards, thermometers.
25. Air-dry. Do not towel-dry sanitized surfaces.
26. Tools: wash, rinse, sanitize scrapers, brushes, chain mail, tongs. Air-dry handles up.
27. Floors: sweep, then wet mop with degreaser. Squeegee to drain. Place dry mats.

9. Closing Checklist and Sign-Off

Task	Initials	Time	Notes
Burners off in order; gas valves checked			
Grates scraped, brushed, and seasoned (thin coat)			
Flat-top cleaned, cooled, and oiled light			
Crumb tray and trough emptied to grease caddy			

Under-unit grease drawer checked/emptied, liner replaced			
Hood filters inspected; washed/reinstalled if needed			
Station surfaces washed-rinsed-sanitized; ppm verified			
Smallwares washed, rinsed, sanitized; air-dried			
Floors swept, mopped, mats reset			
Waste removed; new liners in place			
Lights off at station; pilot status per chef			

Sign-Off:

- Cook closing: print name and initial above. Hand keys and notes to MOD.
- MOD verification: ensure checklist complete. Any issues (gas odor, slow drains, damaged grates) logged and escalated to Priya Nair.